

Gen Z's love of the past

热衷怀旧的 “Z 世代”

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越来越多的年轻人开始回首过去，从复古物件和旧日潮流中寻找慰藉和安全感。比如，他们重新迷上了有线耳机、唱片和笨重的数码相机等“老式”科技产品。本文将探讨一个有趣的问题：人们真的会怀念一个自己从未经历过的时代吗？

词汇：culture and nostalgia 文化和怀旧

1 Today's youth are reinventing what it means to be cool. A surprising number of Gen Zers are actively looking to the past. They are choosing to romanticise old-school tech relics like CDs, wired headphones, and weighty digital cameras. This love for all things vintage extends into their wardrobes with a massive resurgence of Y2K (year 2000) fashion. Friday nights are increasingly filled with board games and classic card games. So why exactly is the most digitally advanced generation trying so hard to rewind ?

2 The answer lies in a desire to slow down and find comfort. Growing up as digital natives has its perks , but Profectus Magazine reveals that around 80% of Gen Z adults worry their generation is far too dependent on technology, while three-quarters feel social media is affecting their mental health. Swapping music streaming for physical CDs or endless social media scrolling for a tactile board game allows them to unplug and step away from the digital noise.

3 This analogue revival could actually be good for everyone. Research by psychologist Dr. Clay Routledge shows that engaging with nostalgic media and traditions can dramatically boost positive moods, reduce anxiety and help people cope with daily stress. It suggests that nostalgia can act as a stabilising , hopeful force, helping a young generation build social confidence.

4 Yet, all of this begs a fascinating question – can a generation truly yearn for a life they never actually lived? Studies published in Profectus Magazine show that nearly 70% of Gen Z adults experience a unique kind of historical nostalgia for eras that predated their own birth. GWI, a global market research company, reports that young people are looking back at the past through rose-tinted glasses , viewing it as a time of genuine human interaction.

5 Though there have been mixed reactions from millennials, ultimately, Gen Z's obsession with the past suggests that no matter how advanced our gadgets get, human beings may always desire a simpler way of living. For a generation that grew up entirely online, going vintage isn't just a fashion statement, it's a total vibe .

测验与练习

一、为本文选择总结句。

- a. Modern technology is bad for you. b. Millennials are annoyed with Gen Z's obsession with the past.
c. Young people want to go back to the simpler times of the past.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. What does 'K' possibly stand for in 'Y2K'? a. 100 b. 1,000 c. 10,000
2. According to the article, most Gen Z adults are concerned about their generation's over-reliance on technology a. True b. False c. Not given
3. According to psychologist Dr. Clay Routledge engaging in newer media and traditions is good for your overall mental health. a. True b. False c. Not given
4. What does GWI suggest about Gen Z's love of the past? a. Gen Z are romanticising the past because of how people interacted. b. Gen Z want to dress like they're from the past. c. Gen Z wish they could live in the past because the tech looked cooler.
5. Gen Z's desire to rewind time suggests that... a. culture works in a cycle and will always repeat itself. b. life is much better now we have newer tech. c. people may always want a simpler time before their own.

三、用下列单词完成对本文的总结。

The 1) _____ of old tech, vintage fashion and 2) _____ board games is an interesting one. It 3) _____ about whether the simplicity of the past outweighs the 4) _____ of our modern, digital lives. It also raises ideas about whether people can 5) _____ for a time that predates themselves.

analogue begs a question cope perks revival tactile yearn

(答案见词汇表后)

词汇表

reinvent

重新创造, 彻底改变 Gen Zer “Z 世代” (指 90 年代后期到 20 年代前期出生的人) romanticise 浪漫化 relic 古董 resurgence 复兴, 再度流行 rewind 回顾过去 perk 好处, 额外福利 tactile 有真实触感的 unplug 拔掉插头, 暂时脱离电子设备 analogue 模拟的 revival 重新流行, 复兴 nostalgic 怀旧的 cope with 应对, 处理 stabilising 起稳定作用的 yearn 渴望 predate 早于, 先于 rose-tinted glasses 玫瑰色眼镜, 看待事物过于乐观 genuine 真正的, 真实的 vibe 感觉, 氛围, 气场

答案

一、为本文选择总结句。

c. Young people want to go back to the simpler times of the past.

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. b. This love for all things vintage extends into their wardrobes with a massive resurgence of Y2K (year 2000) fashion.

2. a. True. Profectus Magazine reveals that around 80% of Gen Z adults worry their generation is far too dependent on technology...

3. c. Not given. It's mentioned that psychologist Dr. Clay Routledge believes that engaging in old media is good for you but doesn't comment on newer media.

4. a. GWI, a global market research company, reports that young people are looking back at the past through rose-tinted glasses, viewing it as a time of genuine human interaction.

5. c. Gen Z's obsession with the past suggests that no matter how advanced our gadgets get, human beings may always desire a simpler way of living.

三、用下列单词完成对本文的总结。

The revival of old tech, vintage fashion and tactile board games is an interesting one. It begs a question about whether the simplicity of the past outweighs the perks of our modern, digital lives. It also raises ideas about whether people can yearn for a time that predates themselves.

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